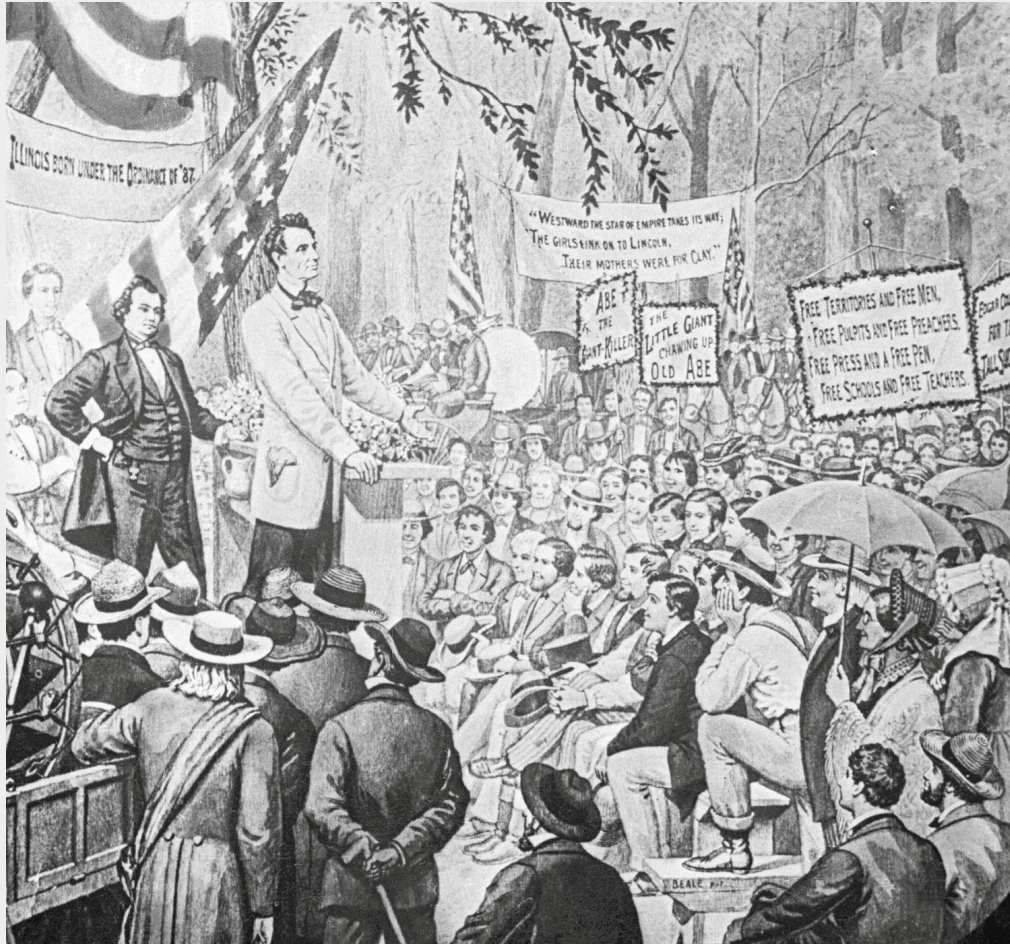




BEFORE

Two of the four major candidates for the presidency in 1860—Lincoln and Douglas—had been opponents in the senatorial campaign in Illinois two years before.



LINCOLN AT THE PODIUM

THE LINCOLN–DOUGLAS DEBATES

In 1858, [Abraham Lincoln](#) accepted the challenge to unseat the powerful Democrat Senator from Illinois, Stephen A. Douglas (see [Bleeding Kansas](#)). Their **seven public debates** were transcribed by reporters and published across the nation. Although his calm, logical arguments frequently discomfited Douglas, **Lincoln lost by 4,000 votes**. Yet he gained a reputation as a **restrained anti-slavery moderate**.

A number of outspoken Southern advocates of secession were opposed not only to any compromise with the North, but also to the Union itself. Known by their opponents as “fire-eaters,” they were hostile to the growing power of the North, and any open discussion of abolition fueled their commitment to an independent South. They included men like Virginian Edmund Ruffin, who had